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Enron Corp.
Case No. EC-2002-01038
Doc No. E9CAB68E7
Date: 01/15/2003
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From: TheStandard.com <media_grok@reply.thestandard.com>
Sent: Mon, 11 Dec 2000 02:24:00 -0800 (PST)
To: alewis@ect.enron.com
Subject: MEDIA GROK: Amazon Gets a Stocking Stuffer

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THE INDUSTRY STANDARD'S
M E D I A G R O K
A Review of Press Coverage of the Internet Economy
==========
| http://www.thestandard.com |

Monday, December 11, 2000

TOP GROKS:
* Amazon gets a stocking stuffer
* Markets beg Florida for mercy
* Iridium won't get rid of 'em

MORE NEWS:
* Index Compiler Moves the Goalposts

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According to the Financial Times, Credit Suisse First Boston analyst Jamie Kiggen put in a few hours working in Amazon's Delaware distribution center and then penned this sunny conclusion: "While our presence there suggests the hiring process could be tightened up a bit, we were struck by the high level of energy and morale among warehouse management and workers alike." Busy bees are happy bees. Kiggen's stint apparently didn't coincide with one of the six or so all-hands meetings that the New York Times reported Amazon held recently to, among other things, squelch unionizing efforts.

You'd think journos might give extra scrutiny to Kiggen's dot-com gig, given the recent brouhaha over the New Yorker's similarly themed piece in its Nov. 27 issue. Writer Rodney Rothman was supposedly aiming for humor, not analysis, when he wrote about his stint working for a Silicon Alley dot-com, according to coverage on the Web site Media News. But in a move that has left journos debating the merits of undercover gigs, he neglected to tell the New Yorker that his mother worked for the firm he infiltrated. And that office massage he wrote so descriptively of? Never really got it. Literary license, you know.

But outlets were glowing about Kiggen's undercover gig. CNNfn, which broke the "news," speculated that Kiggen and the other CS First Boston analysts who cover Amazon "may have set a new precedent this week for just how far researchers will go to obtain information on a company." The Financial Times enthused about Kiggen's ingenuity "in an era when investors often criticise analysts for being spoon-fed by the companies they cover." And, boy, did Kiggen gather some terrific intelligence. According to the Financial Times, Kiggen's experience in the Delaware warehouse, which handles as much as 25 percent of Amazon's orders, "suggested that the company was 'highly likely' to meet or exceed fourth-quarter revenue estimates of $1 billion." All this from an eight-hour stint! We guess we at Media Grok just don't know how to use our time as wisely.

For his part, Kiggen could use a boost for his media profile. He missed being named to Fortune's "all-star analysts" team, but did get pegged for Business Week's piece on Net analysts' fall from grace. Business Week reported criticism of Kiggen's "'lifetime value of a customer' metrics used to justify his bullish Amazon calls" and included the mention in a paragraph on "voodoo valuation." Such paganism applied to a man who truly knows what it means to give.
- Deborah Asbrand

Spying on Amazon

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http://cnnfn.cnn.com/2000/12/08/companies/amazon/index.htm

Analyst Kiggen Dons Warehouse Apparel For Undercover Stint at Amazon.com
http://interactive.wsj.com/articles/SB976496725775080568.htm
(Paid subscription required.)

Undercover Inquiry Brings Christmas Cheer to E-tailers
http://globalarchive.ft.com/globalarchive/articles.html?id=001209001682&query=Kiggen

All-Star Analysts
http://www.fortune.com/fortune/allstars/list.html

The Fall of the Net Analyst
http://www.businessweek.com/2000/00_50/b3711182.htm

Markets Beg Florida for Mercy

For a month now, the market has let itself be led around by the nose by the seesawing fortunes of the presidential contenders in Florida. When Bush is up, the market follows. When Gore's chances rise, the market scowls. Friday was no exception. Around the time of the closing bell, the Florida Supreme Court ordered "an immediate manual recount" of undervotes in all Florida counties. "Stock index futures and some shares slumped" according to CBS MarketWatch's Martin Cej and Chris Kraeuter.

Saturday morning brought the Supreme Court's 5-4 ruling that stopped the recounts, and with it some sigh of relief from investors. The Sunday night press was uncharacteristically optimistic, looking for signs that the uncertainty was close to ending. David Boies, former Microsoft slasher and Napster booster and now attorney for Gore, told Fox News that it could be "the end of the road."

Bloomberg's Monday morning report from Tokyo went further, reporting that U.S. stocks were up, Treasury bonds down as Bush was seen to be the winner. "It looks like we will know who the next president is," Xinyi Lu, chief strategist at Tokai Bank, told Bloomberg. "A Bush victory is bad for bonds because it's good for stocks.''

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Whichever way it goes, it can't wrap up soon enough for financiers who

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